

CSCI 170 Spring 2023 Syllabus

Course Logistics

Instructor	Email	Office	In-person Office Hours
Aaron Cote	aaroncot@usc.edu	SAL 210	Mon/Wed 12:45-2pm
Instructor	Office Hours Zoom Link		Online Office Hours
Aaron Cote	https://usc.zoom.us/j/9589028572		Fri 9:15-10:45am

Lecture 1: TTh 9:30-10:50am, THH 201

Lecture 2: TTh 12:30-1:50pm, THH 101

Discussion 1: Fri 8-9:50am, GFS 106

Discussion 2: Fri 10-11:50am, SAL 101

Discussion 3: Fri 12-1:50pm, THH 202

Discussion 4: Fri 2-3:50pm, SLH 200

Textbook: Essential Discrete Mathematics for Computer Science, by Lewis and Zax.

Websites: <https://blackboard.usc.edu>, <https://piazza.com>, <https://labs.vocareum.com/>

Grading

Artifact	Weight	Date	
Homework (10)	20%	Mondays	11:59pm
Quizzes (4)	40%	Wednesdays	7-8pm
Quiz Self-Assessments	8%	Mondays	11:59pm
Final	32%	Wednesday, May 10th,	7-9pm

Homework

Submit homework and self-assessments to Blackboard, which will be graded pass/no pass (they will **not** be graded on effort). Some homework will be programming assignments which are submitted through Vocareum: all graded test cases will be made available. You may work together on all of these items. Clearly indicate your collaborators at the top of your submission, list any resources you consulted outside of the official course resources, and make sure you understand each of your answers. If you would like to find people to work on homework with, we'll be hosting homework collaboration sessions.

Homework is your primary resource to practice for the quizzes. You are thus strongly encouraged to struggle with the problems on your own before seeking help from your classmates.

Late Policy

You may submit up to three assignments late by up to 24 hours. You do not need to do anything special other than to simply submit at the appropriate time.

Course Grade

The following cutoffs indicate the **minimum** grade you will receive. The instructor reserves the right to lower some or all of the cutoffs at the end of the semester.

Letter	for grade +	for grade	for grade -
A		90%	85%
B	80%	75%	70%
C	65%	60%	55%

Covid Policies and Exam Information

Some people (including the instructor) are still taking Covid very seriously. The class is designed so that, with the exception of the final exam, everything can be done online. No one should ever come to class or office hours while sick, and anyone who is concerned for their health will have distance-learning options.

Quizzes will therefore be conducted through Blackboard. They are individual effort, open-notes, open-book. You may access your textbook, any written or digital notes you've taken or prepared, the course Piazza page, and any resources available on the course Blackboard page. You may ask questions on the exam by making a private post on Piazza.

Tentative Schedule

Day	Topic	Reading	Homework
1/10	Introduction	Ch. 1	HW 0 Out
1/12	Pigeon-Hole Principle		
1/17	Propositional Logic	Ch. 9	HW 1 Out
1/19	Propositional Logic	Ch. 10	
1/24	Logic and Proofs	Ch. 11	HW 2 Out
1/26	Basic Proof Techniques	Ch. 2	
1/31	Proofs		HW 3 Out
2/2	Sets	Ch. 5	
2/7	Functions, Relations	Ch. 6	HW 4 Out
2/9	Induction	Ch. 3	
2/14	Strong Induction	Ch. 4	
2/15	Quiz 1		
2/16	Recursion		
2/21	Recursion		HW 5 Out
2/23	Recursion		
2/28	Order Notation	Ch. 21	HW 6 Out
3/2	Runtime Analysis		
3/7	Sorting		
3/8	Quiz 2		
3/9	Sorting		
	Spring Break		
3/21	Sorting		HW 7 Out
3/23	Structural Induction	Ch. 8	
3/28	Structural Induction		HW 8 Out
3/30	Quantificational Logic	Ch. 12	
4/4	Quantificational Logic		
4/5	Quiz 3		
4/6	Intro to Graph Theory	Ch. 13	
4/11	Graphs and Relations	Ch. 14	HW 9 Out
4/13	Graphs and Proofs	Ch. 16	
4/18	Graph Algorithms	Ch. 17	HW 10 Out
4/20	Graph Algorithms	Ch. 18	
4/25	Graph Induction		
4/26	Quiz 4		
4/27	Extra Topics		
5/10	Final Exam		